

PAA 04-25

SUBJ/ ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDANCE ON THE PROPER COMPUTATION OF CREDITABLE SERVICE AND PAY ENTRY BASE DATE

REF/A/37 U.S.C § 205//

REF/B/DODFMR Volume 7A Chap 1//

REF/C/MCRO 1100.1B/

REF/D/MCO 1560.33//

REF/E/10 USC 12103//

GENTEXT/REMARKS/1. This message is labeled Personnel Administrative Advisory (PAA) 04-25. All current PAAs are located under the reference tab of the Manpower Information System Support Activity (MISSA) portal. https://usmc.sharepoint-mil.us/sites/dcmra_mra_mi_missa. Request addressees disseminate this PAA to subordinate organizations/units as applicable.

1. Background

In October 2024, the Assistant Deputy Commandant for Manpower & Reserve Affairs (ADC M&RA) tasked the Pay Entry Base Date (PEBD) Working Group (WG) to conduct an end-to-end review of PEBD processes and procedures. It was determined there is a need for clear and concise guidance within the Marine Corps that clearly defines creditable service, standardizes the computation of PEBD, and defines the business rules that govern the establishment and adjustment of PEBD.

2. Definitions

2.a PEBD is the actual or constructive date of original entry into the Armed Forces, which is creditable for pay purposes calculated according to a 30-day month, for all months.

2.b Creditable Service is determined by adding together all eligible service periods to determine a Marine's PEBD.

3. Purpose

This advisory provides guidance to administrative personnel for the accurate establishment and adjustment of PEBD by defining periods of creditable service per Ref (a) and Ref (b), standardizing the process of PEBD computation, and applying PEBD business rules.

4. Periods of Creditable Service

4.a. Includes active or inactive service, in accordance with Ref (b), in any of the following:

1. Air Force of the United States (service without specification of a component).
2. Air National Guard.
3. Army National Guard of the United States (ARNGUS).
4. Army, Navy, Marine Corps, Air Force, Space Force, and Coast Guard Reserve.
5. Army of the United States (service without specification of a component).
6. Army Reserve National Guard (ARNG).
7. National Guard and National Guard of the United States.
8. Nurse Corps and Nurse Corps Reserve of the Public Health Service (PHS).

9. PHS and Reserve Corps of the PHS.

10. Regular service in the Army, Air Force, Navy, Coast Guard, and Marine Corps.

4.b. Other periods of creditable service in accordance with Ref (a) and Ref (b) include:

1. Officer, deck officer, or junior engineer service in the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration.
2. Service on a military service retired list, temporary disability retired list, or honorary retired list of any uniformed service or service as a member of the Fleet Reserve or Fleet Marine Corps Reserve.
3. Any period of service during which a member is entitled to retired, retirement, or retainer pay from any uniformed service.
4. Service as a cadet or midshipman at a military academy is always creditable service for an enlisted member who is not commissioned.
5. The time that an enlisted member is retained after expiration of term of service of an Armed Force for medical care or hospitalization for disease or injury incident to service.
6. Service otherwise creditable that is performed before a Marine reaches the statutory age for enlistment, unless the enlistment contract was voided or invalidated for fraud.
7. Active service performed as a temporary member of the U.S Coast Guard Reserve.
8. Service terminated by desertion or dishonorable discharge unless the enlistment was fraudulent and was voided for that reason.
9. Periods of service when a member is detailed to and receiving pay and allowances from any other agency of the United States, even though accruing military pay, and allowances is suspended.
10. Service as a member of the Army, Navy, or Air Force Reserve Officers' Training Corps (ROTC), provided the member has concurrent Selected Reserve (drilling status) for duty performed on or after 1 August 1979.
11. Service as an officer, Army field clerk, flight officer, aviation midshipman, or enlisted member of a uniformed service (as described in Ref (b)).
12. Any period of service which was creditable under any federal statute in effect on 10 January 1962.
13. Service as an enlisted member in a Reserve Component (RC) before beginning Active Duty or Active-Duty Training (ADT) if the Reserve enlistment was entered before 1 January 1985, (including IRR service under DEP). Reference (b) contains additional restrictions that went into effect after 1 January 1985.

Note 1: Constructive Service Credit would apply to certain medical and dental officers that are entitled to extra credit to reflect time spent in medical or dental school. However, this is not a regular occurrence. For further instruction see Ref (b).

Note 2: PEBD for Marine Corps Tuition Assistance Program (MCTAP) recipients within the PLC program is date of commissioning unless individual was prior Drilling Reservist in which case PEBD would remain the same as initial entry Ref (d).

5. Periods of Non-Creditable Service

1. The time served in an enlistment or commission that is terminated (excluding Administrative Separation (ADSEP)), voided, or invalidated as fraudulent.
2. The period of service where underlying medical conditions require medical care or hospitalization was due to misconduct.
3. The time served as a commissioned officer in the Philippine Army.
4. The period a Marine was on the Emergency Officers' Retired List.
5. The period an individual was a member of a state, home, or territorial guard.

6. The time, subsequent to September 14, 1981, that a Marine serves while enrolled in the Armed Forces Health Professions Scholarship (AFHPSP) and Financial Assistance Programs (FAP), or while a Doctor of Medicine (DOM) student at the Uniformed Services University of Health Sciences (USUHS). Use any service creditable on the date of the officer's entry into DOM USUHS to compute the officer's basic pay for longevity purposes while a USUHS student, not to exceed the maximum rate of O-1 pay (Table 1-7) or O-1E pay (Table 1-8), as applicable, or the rate of pay of the member's former pay grade, if greater, as outlined in reference (b)
7. Any period of service as a commissioned officer in the ROTC after 12 October 1964 and prior to 1 August 1979, even if the member held concurrent Reserve status.
8. The time served in an RC before beginning active duty or an initial period of ADT for enlistment in an RC under 10 USC 12103 that was entered into between 1 January 1985 and 28 November 1989.
9. Enlisted service in an RC entered on or after 29 November 1989 and member doesn't perform IDT before beginning active duty or ADT under 10 USC 12103.
10. Enlisted service in an RC Service entered on or after 29 November 1989, under 10 USC 513 (excluding periods of Active Duty).
11. Time an individual was a member of the inactive National Guard.
12. Prior to February 11, 1996, commissioned or warrant officers received full credit for service days regardless of absences or confinement, and enlisted members on active duty as a Reserve Officer. After February 11, 1996, commissioned or warrant officers may not count periods of service listed in Ref (b) other than computing service of basic pay.

6. Calculating Pay Entry Base Date

6.a. Identify the most recent date of entry to duty without a break in service to establish a "foundational" PEBD. Use contractual documents to validate the date a member entered active duty. (i.e. DD Form 4 and DD Form 1666).

6.b. If the member has reported periods of prior service, follow Steps 1-6.

1. Beginning Dates: List the starting date for each separate period of service (year, month, day). Add all the years, months, and days separately. Though the PEBD is determined on a 30-day month, include the 31st day if the beginning date of a period of creditable service begins on that day.

2. Ending Dates (with Adjustments): List the ending date for each separate period of service (year, month, day). Important Rule Changes: If an ending day is the 31st of any month, change it to the 30th. If an ending day is February 28th or 29th, change it to February 30th. Add all the adjusted ending years, months, and days separately.

3. Subtract: Subtract the total of the beginning dates (from step 1) from the total of the adjusted ending dates (from step 2).

4. Add Back Inclusive Days: For each separate period of service (each "gap" in service), add 1 day to the result from step 3. Why: Each period of service is at least one day long. Subtracting the start date from the end date can result in zero days if it's only one day of service, so adding 1 ensures that single day is counted.

5. Convert to Years, Months, and Days: The result from step 4 will be in years, months, and days. Convert any extra months (more than 12) into years, and any extra days (more than 30) into months.

6. Calculate Adjusted PEBD: Subtract the total creditable service (the number of years, months, and days calculated in step 5) from the members most recent ("foundational") PEBD.

Example Calculation:

DEP: 79 12 20 - 80 03 30
Active Service: 80 04 01 - 86 08 13
Add Active Service: 90 08 15 - 92 08 14
= 249 24 36 - 258 19 57

Subtract left column from the right to find total prior service

$$\begin{array}{r} 257 \ 31 \\ 258 \ 19 \ 57 \\ - 249 \ 24 \ 36 \\ \hline 08 \ 07 \ 21 \\ + \quad \quad 3 \\ \hline = 08 \ 07 \ 24 \end{array}$$

Add 1 day for each period of service
Use 30 days = 1 month and 12 month = 1 year if year is greater than 12 months and month greater than 30 days

Subtract left column from the right to find total prior service

$$\begin{array}{r} 258 \ 19 \ 57 \\ - 249 \ 24 \ 36 \\ \hline - 08 \ 07 \ 21 \\ + \quad \quad 3 \\ \hline - 08 \ 07 \ 24 \end{array}$$

Add 1 day for each period of service

Reenlisted: 950710

Subtract total prior service from Reenlistment

$$\begin{array}{r} 18 \\ 1994 \ 06 \ 40 \\ - 1995 \ 07 \ 10 \\ \hline - 08 \ 07 \ 24 \\ \hline = 1986 \ 11 \ 16 \end{array}$$

Use 30 days = 1 month and 12 month = 1 year if year is greater than 12 months and month greater than 30 days

Note 3: Adjusting the foundational PEBD to an earlier, or later, point in time, may result in an increase or decrease to the longevity pay rate to which the Marine is entitled to receive pay.

Note 4: For any Marine with a break in service, reference source documents and compare with the D188 remarks located within the Marine Corps Total Force System (MCTFS) to assist in validating the PEBD.

7. Calculating Pay Entry Base Date – Decision Tree

Note: Reference the Marine's service contract (i.e. DD Form 214, , DD Form 4, for Enlisted or NAVMC 763 for Officers) to determine their accession/reaccessions and appointment/reappointment pathway, respectively.

7.a Enlisted Accession or Reaccessions Pathway Table

Computation of Pay Entry Base Date for Enlisted Marines of the Regular and Reserve Component			
Rule	A	B	C
1	If the individual enlisted prior to 1 Jan 1985 in any branch of the Armed Forces	is placed in the Delay Entry Program (DEP)	then the PEBD is the same as the date of enlistment
2	enlisted on or after 1 Jan 1985 in any branch of the Armed Forces	and is on initial enlistment	the same as the date assigned to active duty
3	reenlisted prior to 1 Jan 1985 in the regular or reserve component of any branch of the Armed Forces	the individual has obligated service remaining from previous enlistment	the same as the date of original entry in the Armed Forces
4	reenlisted on or after 1 Jan 1985 in the regular or reserve component of any branch of the Armed Forces	and obligated service from previous enlistment has not expired prior to reassignment to active duty	
5		and obligated service from initial enlistment expires before assignment to active duty	recomputed to exclude the period immediately following the Marine's MSO to the day prior to assignment to active duty

7.b. Officer Accession or Reaccessions Pathway Table

Accessions/Reaccessions Pathway		And	PEBD =
Rule	A	B	C
1	OCC	Report for initial active duty training	Date assigned to active duty / date arrive to OCS
		Has prior service without break	Date of initial active duty into Armed Forces
		Has prior service with break	Recomputed to exclude period immediately following expiration of initial obligation to the day prior to assignment to active duty.
2	PLC	Report for initial active duty training - MCTAP Yes*	Upon commissioning, recomputed PEBD to exclude periods not on active duty
		Report for initial active duty training - MCTAP No	Date assigned to active duty
		Has prior service without break	Date of initial active duty into Armed Forces
		Has prior service with break	Recomputed to exclude the period immediately following the Marine's MSO to the day prior to assignment to active duty
3	NROTC	Is commissioned	Date of commissioning
		Is commissioned with prior service	Recomputed to include prior creditable service
4	US Naval Academy (Service Academies)	Is commissioned	Date of commissioning
		Is commissioned with prior service	Recomputed to include prior creditable service
5	Interservice Transfers	Is commissioned	Recomputed to include prior creditable service
6	Officer Reappointment	Is commissioned / reappointed	Recomputed to include prior creditable service

Note 5: Rule 2, If PLC, and yes to Marine Corps Tuition Assistance Program (MCTAP), and serving in the SMCR, then PEBD does not change Ref (d). For Law Officers using MCTAP reference MCRCO 1131.1A.

Note 6: For Reserve Officers, same rules as Active Duty Officers with adjustments based on component and qualifying service Ref(b).

Note 7: For creditable service calculation of Reserve Enlisted and Reserve Officers review the Career Retirement Credit Record (CRCR) located within the MCTFS RT07 view.

Note 8: Rule 4 includes commissioned with prior service, including Naval Academy Preparatory School (NAPS).

8. Manpower Strategy Branch, Manpower & Reserve Affairs, has initiated coordination with all accession and reaccessions stakeholders to develop higher level policy that establishes PEBD authorities and governance, defines common PEBD related terminology, reinforces Creditable Service and PEBD calculations, establishes roles and responsibilities, integrates accession and reaccessions reporting units into Marine Corps Administrative Analysis Team (MCAAT) annual inspection cycle, and establishes timely and regular PEBD reviews for all Marines.

8.a. The authority to report and adjust PEBD is restricted to MCRC, TECOM (via the Marine Corps Recruit Depots), the Marine Corps Base Quantico Installation Personnel Administration Center (IPAC), and M&RA (Manpower Information System Support Offices (MISSO), and Manpower Management Separation and Retirement (MMSR)). All requests for review or correction to PEBD must be submitted via chain of command and endorsed by the supporting IPAC to Manpower Management Performance Branch 21 (MMPB-21). All requests for review or correction must include all necessary source documentation.

9. The point of contact regarding this guidance is Lieutenant Colonel Jordan R. Northrup, Manpower Strategy Branch (MX), Manpower & Reserve Affairs (M&RA) at (703) 784-4314 or via e-mail at jordan.r.northrup.mil@usmc.mil.

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